Mixing It - Preparing Qualitative & Quantitative Data Collections for Dissemination: Experiences from the UK Data Archive

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Economic and Social Data Service

Differences & problems

- Typically large scale expensive projects
- Multiple data types:
  - Spss files
  - Individual qualitative interviews – text and audio
  - Group level discussions
  - Case studies
- Far more complex processing job:
  - cross-checking for confidentiality issues
  - more detailed and explanatory catalogue records and user info/guides
  - data delivery issues
- And more complex user support work!

How handled at UKDA?

- Requires:
  - evaluation by acquisition review committee
  - different staff expertise, understanding of research/methods, SPSS data handling
  - preparation of an advanced processing plan
  - oversight and supervision - taken on by senior ESDS Qualidata processing staff - provide strategy & guidance
  - work delegated to selected processing staff
  - Developing specific procedures for the processing unit (processing guides)

Two examples

Neighbourhood Boundaries, Social Disorganisation and Social Exclusion, 2001-2002

The central aim of the research was to investigate the underlying premises of UK neighbourhood crime policies through a comparative study of the responses to crime and disorder within both affluent and deprived neighbourhoods, the extent and nature of informal means of social control utilised by their residents and how collective efficacy is related to social capital and social cohesion. A further aim of the research was to examine the nature of social interaction relating to crime and disorder between the neighbourhoods in order to identify the extent to which such defensive or exclusive strategies may contribute to the social and spatial exclusion of deprived neighbourhoods.

- to examine the relationship between the organisational characteristics of the neighbourhoods and levels of informal social control, including the relationship between mechanisms of formal and informal social control, and;

- to study the construction of territories of control and the importance of boundaries in the neighbourhood governance of crime and disorder.

Neighbourhood Boundaries, Social Disorganisation and Social Exclusion, 2001-2002

Two Scottish cities, Edinburgh and Glasgow, were included in the project. One affluent area and one deprived area were chosen from each city, and the research objectives were addressed utilising a mixed methodology combining quantitative and qualitative data:

- Research methods:
  - individual interviews conducted in four locations with public sector workers
  - focus group interviews with residents
  - a postal survey with residents
- Resulting data:
  - qualitative interview transcripts (N=15)
  - qualitative interview notes (N=1)
  - focus group transcripts (N=6)
  - survey file (N= 1,207)

Details of data files received

RTF format:

- interviews + interview notes, e.g.:
  - Ed aff councillor.rtf
  - Ed dep aff community police.rtf
  - Glas aff councillor.rtf
  - Glas aff community council.rtf etc.
- focus group interviews. e.g.:
  - Ed aff FOCUS GROUP.rtf
  - Glas aff FOCUS GROUP.rtf
  - Glas aff and dep FOCUS GROUP.rtf etc.
- SPSS:
  - Boundaries data.sav
- Details of hard copy doc received
  - Interview samples

Data file conversion/validation

- file name changes
  - FILES FOR ISSUE: Interview/focus group files numbered according to Qualidata standards. See data list file q4841ulist.pdf for details.
- level of processing A (high level of checking, re-labeling, and formatting)
- data file conversion: methods, formats created and validation
  - anonymisation checked and interview text formatted to improve visual appearance (cf prep. for A*)
  - word formats created from RTF files
  - SPSS .sav file converted to SPSS portable file and outputs checked.
  - all files checked for accuracy and completeness
  - variable OCCUPAT removed from the SPSS portable file, a string variable containing specific job information which could potentially identify survey respondents. SOC classification variable included in the data file, so analysis by occupational category is not impaired by the removal of OCCUPAT

Documentation

- doc file conversion: methods, formats created and validation
  - all files checked for accuracy and completeness
  - word and RTF files combined into single PDF user guide and bookmarked to aid navigation
  - data list compiled as per Qualidata standards for interview files

- internal note file prepared
- user read file prepared
- catalogue record prepared

User Guide

RTF:

- USER FILE.rtf INTERVIEW
- TOPIC GUIDE.rtf

Word:

- Questionnaire schedule.doc
- ESRC End of award report 5000.doc

http://www.data-archive.ac.uk/doc/4841/mrdoc/pdf/4841userguide.pdf - Microsoft Internet Explorer

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User Guide
- Note to Users
- End of Award Report
  - 1. Background
  - 2. Objectives
  - 3. Methods
  - 4. Results
  - 5. Activities
  - 6. Outputs
  - 7. Impacts
  - 8. Future Research Priorities
  - References
- Questionnaire: Appendix A: Community Responses to Crime in Scotland
  - 1. The community in your area
  - 2. The Problems in your area
  - 3. People looking after themselves
  - 4. Please tell us a little about yourself
  - 5. Finally
- Key Informants Interview Schedule

Neighbourhood boundaries, informal social control and social exclusion – note to users

1. RESEARCH DESIGN

Our research was conducted in four neighbourhoods in central Scotland. In order to provide a comparative perspective with which to view these processes we selected two deprived and two affluent areas. This meant that we were able to look at the survey and interview data from different contexts and understand more about the kinds of control and problems that existed within different area types. Finally, these areas were paired up and were selected where they were adjacent and whose boundaries were contiguous. This latter criterion proved relatively difficult to apply. We used personal knowledge, maps, census and deprivation indicator data to select a number of areas that might be suitable.

Our selection process included day-long drives around both Edinburgh and Glasgow in order to get a more in-depth idea of the suitability and layout of potential areas and to verify the nature of the boundaries lying between the areas. For example, in a number of cases, areas apparently adjacent were split by impassable barriers such as railway lines or lines of relative resistance to social contact such as busy roads. These visits also involved a consideration of the nature and relative extent of public space and local amenities such as shopping facilities, in other words local sites which might play a role in facilitating social interaction and also as places where disorder might occur.

Both pairs of neighbourhoods could be characterised as comprising an affluent, broadly suburban, neighbourhood at the fringe of the city adjacent to a large-scale estate of public housing. The boundary between the Edinburgh neighbourhoods was marked by a sudden differentiation in the housing stock from low-rise flats to semi-detached private dwellings which backed on to the estate. In the case of Glasgow, playing fields separated the two neighbourhoods providing perhaps something of a 'buffer' between the two areas. Of the two affluent areas; that in Glasgow was comprised of a higher social profile of managers and professionals though both areas are considered to be desirable.

Interviews were carried out with five key actors in each neighbourhood: community police, secondary school teachers, councillors, youth group representative and community councillors. In each of the deprived areas we also went to the local Social Inclusion Partnership (SIP) agency. These interviews were designed to provide an overview of the themes we had raised in the survey and, in particular, to look at the social connections within and between the pairs of neighbourhoods. Finally, the interviews were used to establish whether there was any use of outside agencies as the 'champions' of residents in the sense that Baumgartner (1988) used the term. In other words, was there support for the hypothesis that in areas of greater affluence official agencies are used to support the idea of a moral minimalism in engagement?

The final stage of the research was the use of focus groups. Six were conducted with one in each neighbourhood and two more with residents drawn unwittingly from across each pair of neighbourhoods. The focus groups were used to generate further

8.5 x 11 in

Data listing

- list of contents of research collection – based on face-sheet variables of sample
- acts as a point of entry for secondary user
- qualitative data: template approach – interviewee/case study characteristics
- See example

http://www.data-archive.ac.uk/doc/4841/mrdoc/pdf/q4841ulist.pdf - Microsoft Internet Explorer

Study No: 4841
Neighbourhood Boundaries, Social Disorganisation and Social Exclusion, 2001-2002
Atkinson, R.

Interview ID	Interviewee occupation/interest	Location	Gender	Interview	No. of Pages	Text Filename
int01	Councillor	Edinburgh Affluent ward	M	11/10/01	12	int01
int02	Community Police Officer	Edinburgh Deprived/Affluent wards	~	09/10/01	3	int02
int03	Area Renewal staff member	Edinburgh Deprived ward	~	~	17	int03
int04	Community Police Officer	Edinburgh Deprived ward	M	20/12/01	11	int04
int05	Councillor	Edinburgh Deprived ward	M	~	12	int05
int06	Housing Officer	Edinburgh Deprived ward	~	~	14	int06
int07	Community Council Officer/Community Police Officer	Glasgow Affluent ward	M/M	~	18	int07
int08	Community Police Officer	Glasgow Affluent ward	~	~	11	int08
int09	Councillor	Glasgow Affluent ward	~	~	10	int09
int10	Teacher	Glasgow Affluent ward	M	~	11	int10
int11	Community (Safety) Forum Officer	Glasgow Deprived ward	F	~	16	int11
int12	Councillor	Glasgow Deprived ward	F	~	17	int12
int13	Community Police Officer	Glasgow Deprived ward	M	~	7	int13
int14	Youth Project Officer	Glasgow Deprived ward	F	~	7	int14
int15	Youth Project Officer	Glasgow Deprived ward	F	~	15	int15
Focus Group Interviews						
fg01	Residents' focus group	Edinburgh Affluent ward	M/F	~	21	fg01
fg02	Residents' focus group	Edinburgh Deprived/Affluent ward	M/F	08/03/02	21	fg02
fg03	Residents' Association focus group	Edinburgh Affluent ward	M/F	12/11/01	15	fg03
fg04	Residents' focus group	Glasgow Deprived/Affluent ward	M/F	~	21	fg04
fg05	Residents' focus group	Glasgow Affluent ward	M/F	~	18	fg05
fg06	Residents' focus group	Glasgow Deprived ward	M/F	~	30	fg06
Notes						
note01	Notes from interview with Youth Development Group representative	Edinburgh Deprived ward	F	09/10/01	3	note01

This study also includes a quantitative data file ('boundariesdata') which contains responses to the survey conducted as part of the research project.

11 x 8.5 in
1 of 1

User read/internal note file

Records data and documentation problems

- the file 'glasaffcommunitypolice.rtf' under no issue is actually an interview with a community police officer from Edinburgh Affluent and Deprived Wards, and is a duplicate of file int02 (internal)
- quantitative data file 'boundaries data' contains a number of variables with set missing values of '9'. These are not labeled, but denote 'Not applicable/don't know' responses unless otherwise stated (external/internal)
- Notes to Data Delivery this is a mixed methods study - the qualitative data is available in RTF and Word formats, and the quantitative file in SPSS, Stata and tab formats (internal). Data ALWAYS delivered as full set
- See example of read file

Catalogue record

- full description of various data types in Main Topics (see handout)
  - 'Topics covered in the individual and focus group interviews include ….
  - 'Topics covered in the quantitative data file include..
- use of controlled vocabulary in DDI: Kind of Data, that relate specifically to qualitative data:
  - *Kind of data*: textual data: in-depth interview transcripts; numeric data; Individuial (micro) level
- Use of DDI: Coverage fields
  - *Observation Units:* Individuals; Groups
- Use of DDI: Methodology elements:

Use of DDI Methodology fields

- *Time Dimensions:* Cross-sectional (one-time) study
- *Sampling Procedures:* normally detailed…
- *Number of Units:* 15 individual interviews, six focus group interviews, one set of interview notes and one quantitative data file containing survey information gathered from 1,207 respondents
- *Method of Data Collection:* Face-to-face interview; Postal survey; Focus group
- *Weighting:* Not applicable

Second example: complex...

Employment and Working Life Beyond the Year 2000: Employee Attitudes to Work in Call Centres and Software Development

The research was based on case studies of four call centres and six software development firms representing either city or non-city locations. The focus of study was a range of phenomena at different levels of analysis (e.g., sector/workforce, work organisation, attitudes and identity). The interdisciplinary nature of the phenomena and issues to be studied suggested both a deductive and inductive approach rather than a single theoretical framework or methodology. Consequently, the study was designed both to test explicit research hypotheses through large sample questionnaires distributed across the case study companies, and to explore organisational processes and individual identity through different types of in-depth interviews with small samples over time.

Data collection

- archive search (e.g. company documents)
- exploratory interviews with key informants (managers, call centre operators, software developers)
- observation of management meetings and work processes
- work diaries (for software work only)
- guided conversation with key groups (e.g. inductees, team managers, employee representatives)
- self-report employee attitude questionnaire
- self-report software team attitude questionnaire
- taped and transcribed semi-structured workplace interviews
- taped and transcribed in-depth home-based interviews

Numbers….

- Workplaces
  - eleven company workplaces (four call centres; six software development firms)
- Employees within workplaces
  - 1163 employee attitude questionnaires returned (855 call centre; 308 software)
  - 329 exploratory interviews (243 call centre; 86 software)
  - 158 workplace interviews (86 call centre; 72 software)
  - 26 home-based in-depth interviews (14 call centre; 12 software)
- Teams/employees within workplaces
  - 62 software employee team questionnaires returned
  - 85 software employee diaries returned
  - 11 teams

Resulting data

- Quantitative data (spss):
  - employee attitude questionnaire = 1163 cases x 397 vars
  - team and work diary questionnaire = 92 cases x 861 vars

- Qualitative data (word):
  - organised into separate files for a single case study company.
  - each case study file includes all types of qualitative data
    - exploratory interview and observation field notes (coded by researchers)
    - semi-structured workplace interview transcripts
    - in-depth home-based interview transcripts)

Resulting documentation

- description of Methodology
- case Study Data Summary
- sample Employee Attitude Questionnaire
- sample Software Employee Work Diary
- sample Software Employee Team Questionnaire
- workplace Interview Schedule
- home-based Interview Schedule
- example of qualitative data for Beta company

And to processing…

- ✓ all data anonymised by depositor!
- all data and doc **very** well organised
- Data listing to be delivered as a searchable read-only spreadsheet , rather than pdf of excel spread sheet

Summary

- complex processing jobs…e.g. confidentiality
- require sufficient documentation to enable user to understand study methods and resulting data…
- …and relationships between data
- user support…best practice is how to use these kinds of data?
- analysis often not truly triangulated…but disparate –two teams - one conducts and writes up qual. part and the other does the quant. side…not true mixing of methods!
- However results are often contradictory!
- We will be developing our recommendations in a processing guide